

Learning How to Learn: Evidence on the Table

学会学习：摆上桌面的证据

Theme: 学习方法与教育 · New: 45 · Review: 18 · Planned cumulative progress: 45/6, 127

English Story

The staff week had to become evidence, and evidence is a **demanding** master. Among the three hundred pages of notes, only a handful could survive a stranger's reading. "It is **easy** to be **nice** about a school," the teacher said. "It is harder to be accurate. **Please treat** the week as a **problem**, not as a story." **Much** of the material, she added, was **already stale** the day it was written.

The team **already** knew where the weakness was. A **pretty** table can hide a **hasty** sample; a **cheerful** summary can bury a **misery**. "We must **observe**, not celebrate," Lin wrote. "You are **crazy**," Maya said, laughing. "But you are also right." The **bulk** of the evidence was **delicate**: a girl who had never been asked, a kid who had learned to read from a cereal box, and a boy who could remember every word of a notice but not the name of the office that posted it.

The **eventual** report was a **surgical** document. It listed what the group had seen, what it had assumed, and where the two differed. A **skilled typist** prepared three copies; a **handsome** folder carried them to the faculty office. An early draft had been **much** longer. One sentence, quoted later in the student paper, read: "The **honor** of a school is not in its buildings but in the questions it allows."

The **irony** was not lost on them. A university that charged high **tuition** could not **discriminate** between students who asked and students who stayed **absent**. An **enterprising** professor, **eager** to help, wanted a mightier conclusion than the data allowed, and the **uneasy** silence that followed was, in turn, an education. A **clever** remark about statistics broke it. "You ask for the impossible," she said. "No," Maya said. "We ask for the **eventual**." The **wit** in the room was **merry**; the **impatience** was not.

A **cloudy** afternoon brought a **fantastic** offer: a conference slot, a **congratulatory** letter, and a chance to present the week as a triumph. Those pages, however, would need a **badly** lit corridor to look impressive, and the team refused the triumphant part. A **commonplace** sentence, they decided, was worth more than a **pretty** one, and an **ironic** footnote about the information they lacked could **heighten** the contrast. The work was **tricky**, the timetable **adventurous**, and one table **already** obsolete. Their **proficiency** would be measured by what they left out. "Yes," the professor said. "That is the art of it."

中文翻译

职工周必须变成证据，而证据是一位要求很高的主人。在三百页笔记中，只有少数几页能经受陌生人的阅读。“对一所学校说好话很容易，”那位教师说，“做到准确更难。请把这个星期当作一个问题，而不是一个故事。”她又说，其中很多材料在写下的当天就已经过时了。

团队早就知道弱点在哪里。一张漂亮的表格可以掩盖草率的样本；一份快活的摘要可以埋葬一份痛苦。“我们必须观察，而不是庆祝，”林伟写道。“你疯了，”曼雅笑着说，“但你也说对了。”大部分证据都很微妙：一个从未被问过的女孩、一个从麦片盒上学会认字的孩子，以及一个能记住通知里每一个字、却记不住张贴通知的办公室名字的男孩。

最终的是一份外科手术式的文件。它列出了小组看到的、他们假设的，以及两者不同之处。一位熟练的打字员准备了三份；一只大方的文件夹把它们送到了教工办公室。早期草稿要长得多。其中一句话后来被学生报引用：“一所学校的荣誉不在于它的建筑，而在于它允许被提出的问题。”

其中的讽刺他们并没有错过。一所收取高额学费的大学，不能因为学生是否提问就区别对待他们，也不能对缺席者视而不见。一位有事业心的教授热心想帮忙，想要一个比数据允许的更有力的结论；随之而来的不安沉默，反过来也是一堂教育课。一句关于统计的聪明评论打破了沉默。“你在要求不可能的事，”她说。“不，”曼雅说，“我们在要求那个最终会成立的东西。”屋里的机智是愉快的，急躁则不是。

一个多云的下午带来了一个奇妙的提议：一个会议名额、一封祝贺信，以及把这一周说成胜利的机会。然而那些页面要靠一条照明很差的走廊才显得动人，团队拒绝了“胜利”那部分。他们认定，一句平常的话比一句漂亮的话更值钱，而关于他们所缺信息的一句讽刺性脚注，反而能加强对比。工作很棘手，时间表富于冒险，有一张表格已经作废。他们的熟练程度将由他们省略了什么来衡量。“是的，”教授说，“这就是它的艺术所在。”

Core Vocabulary · 核心词汇

Word / Pronunciation	Context meaning / source example
much mʌtʃ POS: n	n. 大量, 许多, 重要的事; a. 很多的, 重要的; adv. 多, 甚, 几乎 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a great amount or extent; a. (quantifier used with mass nouns) great in quantity or degree or extent; r. to...
problem ˈprɒbləm POS: n	n. 问题, 难题; a. 成问题的, 难处理的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a state of difficulty that needs to be resolved; n. a question raised for consideration or solution
already ɔ:l'redi POS: adv	adv. 已经, 早已 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: r. prior to a specified or implied time
easy 'i:zi POS: a	a. 容易的, 缓缓的, 舒适的, 从容的, 宽容的, 流畅的, 随便的, 自在的, 疲软的; adv. 容易地, 慢慢地 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. posing no difficulty; requiring little effort; s. not hurried or forced; a. free from worry or anxiety; s. af...
nice nais POS: a	a. 美好的, 和蔼的, 正派的, 做得好的, 精密的, 细微的, 挑剔的, 谨慎的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a city in southeastern France on the Mediterranean; the leading resort on the French Riviera; a. pleasant o...
please pli:z POS: adv	adv. 请; vt. 使高兴, 合...的心意, 取悦; vi. 使人满意, 讨好, 愿意, 敬请 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. give pleasure to or be pleasing to; v. be the will of or have the will (to); v. give satisfaction; r. used in...
pretty 'priti POS: a	a. 漂亮的, 优美的, 机灵的, 狡猾的, 恰当的; adv. 相当, 颇 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s. pleasing by delicacy or grace; not imposing; s. (used ironically) unexpectedly bad
treat tri:t POS: n	n. 宴请, 款待; vt. 视为, 对待, 论述, 治疗, 款待; vi. 讨论, 谈判, 作东 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. an occurrence that causes special pleasure or delight; v. interact in a certain way; v. provide treatment fo...
observe əb'zə:v POS: vt	vt. 觉察到, 遵守, 注意到, 庆祝; vi. 注意, 评论 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. watch attentively; v. behave as expected during of holidays or rites; v. stick to correctly or closely; v. co...
crazy 'kreizi POS: a	a. 发狂的, 狂热的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. someone deranged and possibly dangerous; s. foolish; totally unsound; s. possessed by inordinate excitement; ...
honor 'ɒnə POS: n	n. 荣誉, 头衔, 信用, 尊敬, 名誉, 阁下, 勋章; vt. 尊敬, 授予荣誉, 承兑, 实践 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the state of being honored; n. the quality of being honorable and having a good name; n. a woman's virtue or...
badly 'bædli POS: adv	adv. 严重地, 恶劣地, 极度地 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: r. to a severe or serious degree; r. evilly or wickedly; r. in a disobedient or naughty way; r. with great inten...
clever 'klevə POS: a	a. 聪明的, 精明的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s. showing inventiveness and skill
eager 'i:gə POS: a	a. 热心的, 渴望的, 热望的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. having or showing keen interest or intense desire or impatient expectancy
bulk bʌlk POS: n	n. 大小, 体积, 大块, 大多数; vt. 显得大, 显得重要 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the property of something that is great in magnitude; n. the property possessed by a large mass; v. stick ou...
delicate 'delikət POS: a	a. 细致优雅的, 微妙的, 美味的; [医] 柔弱的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. exquisitely fine and subtle and pleasing; susceptible to injury; s. marked by great skill especially in met...
skilled 'skild POS: a	a. 熟练的; [经] 熟练的, 有技能的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. having or showing or requiring special skill
handsome 'hænsəm POS: a	a. 英俊的, 大方的, 慷慨的, 相当可观的, 美观的, 灵敏的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s pleasing in appearance especially by reason of conformity to ideals of form and proportion; s given or givin...
absent 'æbsənt POS: a	a. 缺席的, 不在的, 缺乏的, 漫不经心的; vt. 使缺席 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. go away or leave; a. not being in a specified place; s. lost in thought; showing preoccupation
irony 'aiərəni POS: n	n. 反语, 讽刺, 具有讽刺意味的事 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. incongruity between what might be expected and what actually occurs; n. a trope that involves incongruity b...
misery 'mizəri POS: n	n. 痛苦, 悲惨, 不幸, 穷困 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a state of ill-being due to affliction or misfortune; n. a feeling of intense unhappiness

Word / Pronunciation	Context meaning / source example
fantastic fæn'tæstɪk POS: a	a. 奇妙的, 稀奇的, 空想的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s. extraordinarily good or great; used especially as intensifiers; s. fanciful and unrealistic; foolish; s. exi...
wit wɪt POS: n	n. 机智, 智力, 头脑, 理智, 妙语, 机智的人 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a message whose ingenuity or verbal skill or incongruity has the power to evoke laughter
cheerful 'tʃɪəfʊl POS: a	a. 快活的, 高兴的, 兴高采烈的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. being full of or promoting cheer; having or showing good spirits; s. pleasantly (even unrealistically) opti...
surgical 'sɜ:dʒɪkl POS: a	a. 外科的, 外科医生的, 手术上的; n. 外科病例, 外科病房, 外科手术 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. of or relating to or involving or used in surgery; a. relating to or requiring or amenable to treatment by...
ironic aɪə'ronɪk POS: a	a. 冷嘲的, 挖苦的, 反话的, 讽刺的, 令人啼笑皆非的, 出乎意料的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s. characterized by often poignant difference or incongruity between what is expected and what actually is
eventual ɪ'ventʃʊəl POS: a	a. 最后的, 终于的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s. expected to follow in the indefinite future from causes already operating
uneasy ˌʌn'i:zi POS: a	a. 心神不安的, 不自在的, 不稳定的, 不舒服的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. lacking a sense of security or affording no ease or reassurance; s. relating to bodily unease that causes d...
mighty 'maɪti POS: n	n. 有势力的人; a. 有势力的, 强大的, 有力的; adv. 很, 极 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s. having or showing great strength or force or intensity; r. (Southern regional intensive) very; to a great d...
tuition tju:'ɪʃən POS: n	n. 学费, 讲授 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a fee paid for instruction (especially for higher education)
tricky 'tri:ki POS: a	a. 狡猾的, 机敏的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s not to be trusted; s having concealed difficulty; s marked by skill in deception
discriminate dɪs'krɪmɪneɪt POS: v	v. 区别, 差别待遇 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. recognize or perceive the difference; v. treat differently on the basis of sex or race; v. distinguish; a. ma...
merry 'meri POS: a	a. 快乐的, 愉快的, 嬉戏作乐的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s full of or showing high-spirited merriment; s offering fun and gaiety; s quick and energetic
demanding dɪ'mɑ:ndɪŋ POS: a	a. 要求高的, 费力的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. requiring more than usually expected or thought due; especially great patience and effort and skill
heighten 'haɪtn POS: vt	vt. 增高, 提高, 加强; vi. 升高, 变大 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. become more extreme; v. make more extreme; raise in quantity, degree, or intensity; v. increase the height of
commonplace 'kɒmənples POS: n	n. 寻常事, 老生常谈, 普通的东西; a. 平凡的, 普通的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s. completely ordinary and unremarkable; s. not challenging; dull and lacking excitement
adventurous əd'ventʃərəs POS: a	a. 喜欢冒险的, 有进取心的, 危险的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. willing to undertake or seeking out new and daring enterprises
impatience ɪm'peɪjəns POS: n	n. 性急, 难耐, 焦急, 急躁 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a restless desire for change and excitement; n. a dislike of anything that causes delay
stale steɪl POS: n	n. 尿; a. 不新鲜的, 陈腐的, 疲惫的, 陈旧的; vt. 使变旧, 走味; vi. 变陈旧, 走味, 失时效, 撒尿 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. urinate, of cattle and horses; a. lacking freshness, palatability, or showing deterioration from age
proficiency prə'fɪjəns POS: n	n. 精通, 熟练, 精练 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the quality of having great facility and competence; n. skillfulness in the command of fundamentals derivin...
cloudy 'klaudi POS: a	a. 多云的, 有愁容的, 云的, 浑浊的; [建] (混) 浊的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s. lacking definite form or limits; a. full of or covered with clouds; s. (of liquids) clouded as with sediment
enterprising 'entəpraɪzɪŋ POS: a	a. 有魄力的, 有进取心的, 有事业心的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. marked by imagination, initiative, and readiness to undertake new projects
hasty 'heɪsti POS: a	a. 匆匆的, 轻率的, 性急的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s. excessively quick; s. done with very great haste and without due deliberation

Word / Pronunciation	Context meaning / source example
typist 'taɪpɪst POS: n	n. 打字员 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. someone paid to operate a typewriter
congratulatory kən'grætʃəleɪtəri POS: a	a. 庆祝的, 祝贺的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s. expressive of sympathetic pleasure or joy on account of someone's success or good fortune